

Ally — MVP 1.0 Definition

- **Status** — Finalized scope, pending build of the launch-critical fixes in §6
- **Revision** — 3. Rev 2 added Decision 5 (no free tier; coupons are the acquisition mechanism) and the open decisions it creates, in §9. Rev 3 adds P0-11/12/13: the diagnosis engine has never been run against a live model, and the defaults hide that rather than surface it.
- **Date** — 5 September 2026
- **Product** — Ally, the Founder DNA Platform. An AI co-founder coach that diagnoses the *founder* first, then the business, then the root cause sitting at their intersection.
- **Stack** — FastAPI + SQLAlchemy + Alembic on Supabase Postgres · Vite + React 19 + Tailwind + react-router · Backend on AWS App Runner/ECS Fargate, frontend on Vercel · Razorpay (INR) · Supabase Auth

0. Decisions locked for 1.0

#	Decision	Choice
1	Billing model	Auto-renewing mandate. Razorpay Subscriptions with a real mandate, a working cancel path, and a downgrade sweep on expiry. This is what the UI already promises the founder, so it is the model we make true rather than the promise we retract.
2	Coupons	Coupons are the acquisition mechanism, not a promo. Admin-issued codes: percent off, flat off, or a 100% comp. One redemption per founder, an expiry, a redemption cap. Upgraded from "simple launch codes" by Decision 5 — see §5.3.
3	Feature scope	Keep everything currently built, and every feature must work. Nothing shipped is pulled or flag-hidden. Nothing half-built ships visible.
4	Access	Waitlist-gated launch. Signup stays approval-only; the gate is not lifted in 1.0.
5	Free tier	Nothing is free. Every founder pays something. The Free trial tier is withdrawn from the ladder. Access is obtained by paying, or by redeeming a coupon — including a 100% comp that grants a plan outright. The coupon, not a trial, is what lets a founder start without paying full price.

Consequence of #3: MVP 1.0 is a *quality and correctness* release, not a feature-cut release. The surface is already wide, so the launch bar is that **every screen a founder can reach tells the truth**, every rupee charged is charged correctly, and **no feature a founder can see is unfinished** — that last clause makes Know My Energy (\$1.5) and the discovery-call reminder scheduler (§1.6) required work, not optional.

Consequence of #5, and it is the larger one: **the paywall moves from the end of the journey to the front of it**. Today a founder is diagnosed, reads the report, and only then meets a wall — Ally has proved itself before it asks for money. With no free tier the ask comes *before* the proof, which is precisely what the coupon exists to soften. It also changes what the waitlist is: approval stops meaning "you may sign up" and starts meaning "you may sign up, and here is your code."

Exactly where that paywall sits is not yet decided (§9, Decision 1). The three candidate positions are marked in the journey diagram in §2, and the rest of this document is written to hold for any of them.

1. Final feature list

Legend: **Live** = built and working · **Fix** = built but has a launch-critical defect (see §6) · **Finish** = partially built, must be completed for 1.0

1.1 Identity & access

Feature	Status	Notes
Email + emailed OTP + password sign-in (Supabase)	Live	<code>frontend/src/services/auth.js</code>
Backend-issued session tokens (access + rotating refresh)	Live	<code>POST /auth/session</code> , <code>/resume</code> , <code>/refresh</code> , <code>/logout</code> , <code>GET /auth/me</code> , <code>/auth/status</code>
Waitlist gate — unapproved emails bounced to the waitlist	Live	Client-side courtesy; the real gate is waitlist approval in Supabase
Founder auto-provisioning on first login	Live	Behind <code>ENABLE_FOUNDER_PROVISIONING</code>
Session survives reload; refresh-token rotation	Live	A refresh token works exactly once

1.2 Onboarding (the guided flow)

Feature	Status
Expectation → Welcome → Ally intro (3 tabs: Founder-First, Root-Cause Chain, Clarity Method)	Live
Consent capture (terms + diagnosis consent), append-only ledger	Live
Profile build — 4-section, path-branching questionnaire	Live
Stage tour, summary, validate, problem statement	Live
Resume a partially completed onboarding	Live
Hand-off to the real backend diagnosis (no scripted fake sequence)	Live

1.3 The diagnosis engine — the core product

Feature	Status	Notes
Phase 1 — Founder DNA journey	Live	<code>/app/founder-dna-journey</code> ; <code>/diagnosis/start</code> 409s until complete
Phase 2 — Current Problem	Live	<code>/app/current-problem</code>
Phase 3 — Adaptive business diagnosis	Live	<code>/app/diagnosis</code> ; server-side session, resumable
Adaptive question selection over the seeded bank	Live	330 questions, 807 root causes, 3,920 root-cause weights, 97 interventions, 124 problems
Stage-scoped pillars — never ask a pre-launch solo founder about revenue concentration	Live	<code>diagnosis/stage_scope.py</code>
Per-stage question budget	Live	<code>founder_stages.question_budget</code>
Confidence scoring + routing bands (Continue <60 · Validate 60–80 · Report ≥80)	Live	<code>reasoning/engines/confidence.py</code>
Voice input inside the diagnosis	Live	All tiers
Reasoning engines: archetype, business health, root cause, stage detection, psychological state, distress language, symptom detection, consistency, recommendation, action plan	Live, but LLM-gated	19 engines under <code>reasoning/engines/</code> . Nine independent flags decide whether each reasons by model or degrades to a deterministic path, and all nine default to off — see P0-11
Lifetime diagnosis cap enforced per plan	Live	Only <i>completed</i> diagnoses count

1.4 Outputs

Feature	Status
Clarity Report (scored diagnosis + single Clarity Score)	Live
Founder DNA card — archetype and dimension profile	Live
Business DNA card — 6 readiness pillars (Founder Readiness 25 · Market Clarity 20 · Revenue Maturity 20 · Product & Execution 15 · Team & Leadership 10 · Strategic Clarity 10)	Live
Next Steps — server-generated recommendations	Live
Report document generation	Live
Honest empty states before any diagnosis exists	Live

1.5 The ongoing workspace

Feature	Status	Plan gate
Dashboard — greeting, health cards, plan badge, next call	Live	All
Ally Chat — grounded in the founder's own diagnosis, streaming, attachments + vision, suggestions, links, memory	Live	Plus+
Voice in chat	Live	Plus+
Plan Your Day — goals and tasks	Live	Plus+
Goals	Live	Plus+
Next Steps	Live	Plus+
Vision	Live	Pro
Recommendations	Live	Pro
Knowledge-graph chat	Live	Pro
Email notifications	Live	Pro
Know My Energy	Finish	Pro — declared in the catalog, founder-facing implementation incomplete. Required for 1.0 under Decision 3: it is sold on the pricing page, so it must work.
Frameworks library + detail	Live	All
Achievements	Live	All
Journey timeline	Live	All
Notifications feed	Live	All
Help & Support assistant on every page	Live	All
Founder profile, settings, preferences	Live	All
Feedback capture	Live	All

1.6 Discovery calls

Feature	Status	Notes
Slot listing against live Google Calendar	Live	Pro sees slots from tomorrow (1-day lead); everyone else 3 days

Feature	Status	Notes
Booking as a request the team confirms	Live	Deliberate: payment is collected offline, seam is <code>payment_reference + pending → confirmed</code>
Email confirmation + 24h / 1h reminders	Finish	Code works; no scheduler runs it in production
₹300 per call once the free allowance is used	Fix	Every tier currently has <code>free_calls_per_month = 0</code>

1.7 Money

Feature	Status
Plan catalog — one source of truth for price, credits, ceilings, features	Live
Server-side entitlement checks (UI only mirrors them)	Live
Credit ledger, append-only, with lazy settlement (expiry + renewal without a cron)	Live
Daily token ceilings, metered separately per feature	Live
Unbilled-usage reconciliation queue	Live
Razorpay checkout for a paid plan	Fix — one-time order, not a mandate
Webhook-granted plans, idempotent, signature-verified	Live
Recurring renewal / cancel / downgrade on expiry	Build — \$5
Coupons — percent, flat, and 100% comp	Build — \$5.3
Withdraw the Free trial from the sold ladder	Build — \$5.5. <code>free</code> is <i>retained</i> as the internal no-access identifier, not deleted
Comp grant path — a ₹0 redemption that never touches the gateway	Build — \$5.3. Razorpay cannot create a ₹0 order or mandate, so this cannot be a discounted checkout
₹300 / 120-credit top-up	Build — advertised by the API, no checkout path exists

1.8 Admin

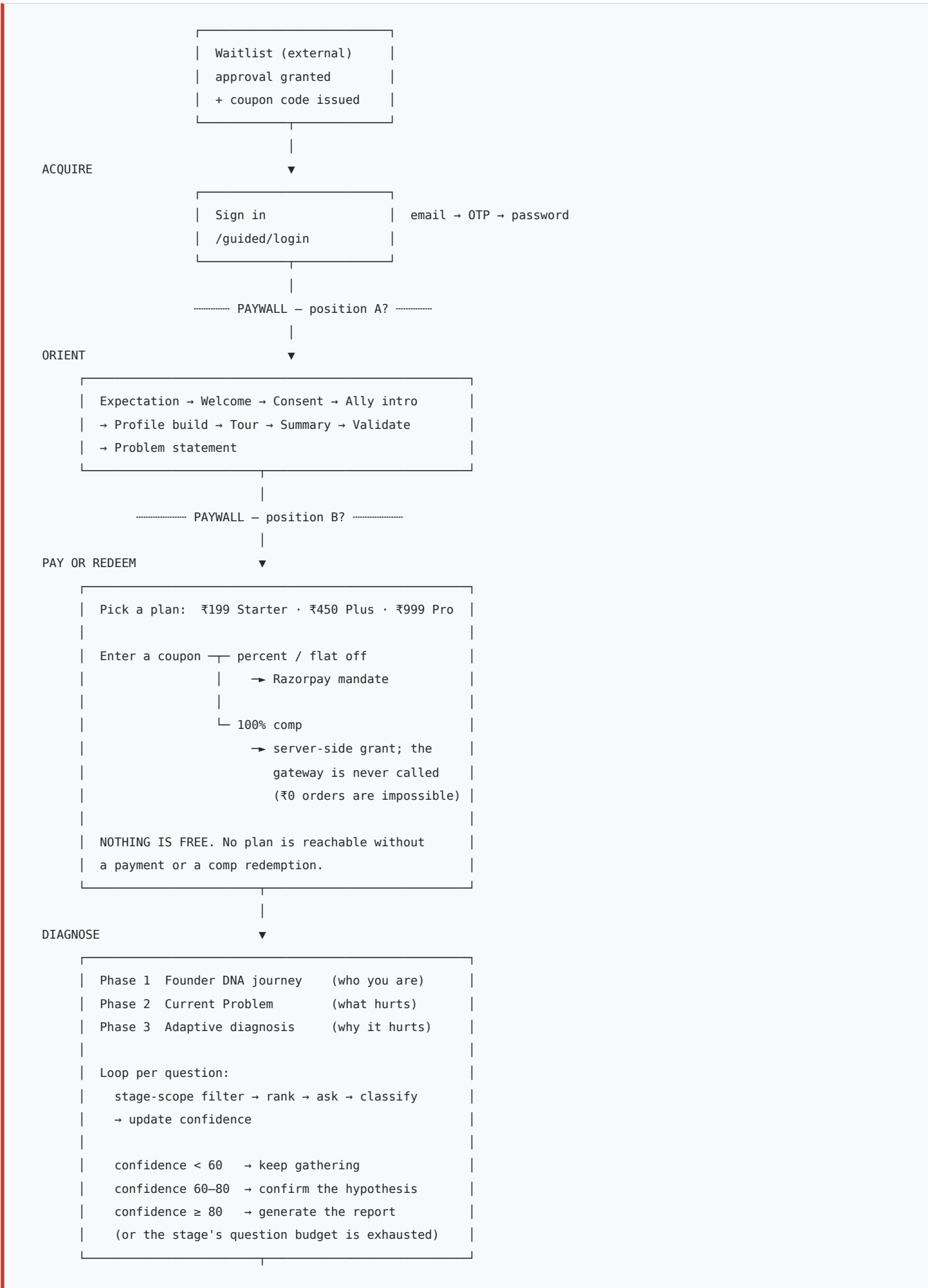
Full detail in §4. Live today: RBAC (3 roles), user search and detail, credit adjustment and bulk grants, subscription patch, diagnosis/conversation resets, account suspension and deletion, privacy-request queue, feature flags, broadcasts, usage and cost metrics, founder feedback, report regeneration, conversation inspection, and an immutable audit log.

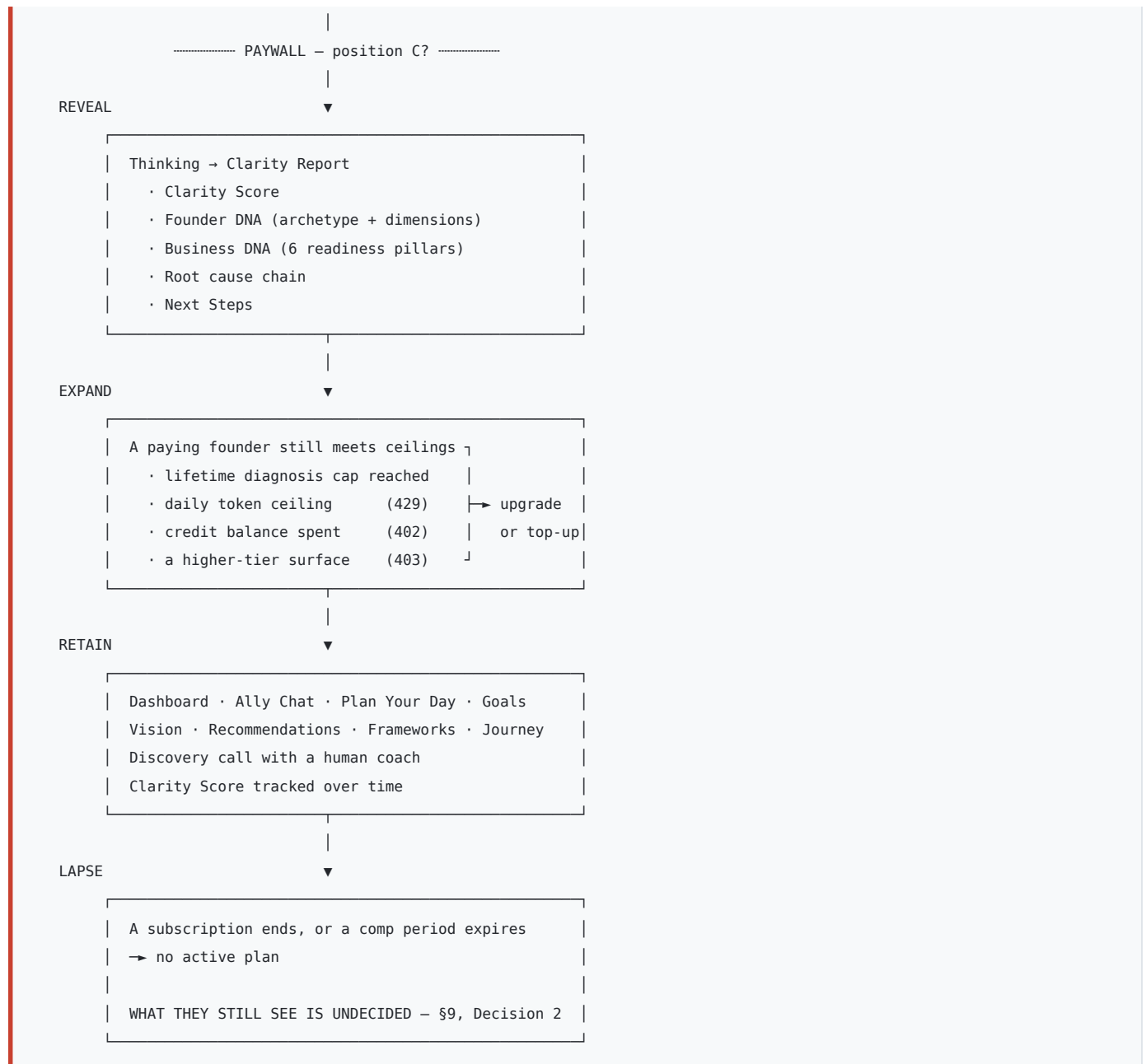
1.9 Trust, privacy, platform

Feature	Status
Data export (JSON)	Live
Restrict processing (reversible)	Live
Withdraw consent	Live
Account deletion with 30-day scheduled erasure	Live — sweep endpoint exists, needs a scheduler
Terms of Service and Privacy Policy pages	Live
Error boundaries per route group	Fix — does not reset on navigation
Sentry error reporting	Live

Feature	Status
Stale-chunk recovery after a deploy	Live
Mobile 375px verified across the main routes	Live

2. User journey & process flow





Reading the diagram. The three **PAYWALL - position ?** markers are the open decision in §9. Exactly one becomes real and the other two disappear: everything above the chosen marker is reachable without paying, everything below it is not. The rest of this document is written to hold whichever is chosen.

The monetisation logic. Ally is not a free product and no longer has a trial. Every founder pays, and the only route to a plan without paying full price is a coupon — a discount, or a 100% comp that grants the plan outright. This is a deliberate trade: a trial converts on *proof* (the founder has seen the diagnosis be right about them before they are asked for money), whereas a coupon converts on *permission* (the founder is asked before Ally has shown anything, and the code is what makes that ask reasonable). The consequence is that the coupon slate is no longer a marketing lever — it **is** the funnel, and a launch with no codes issued is a launch with no signups.

The pricing ladder reads as three sentences:

- **₹199 Starter** — "Buy the answer." One adaptive diagnosis and the Clarity Report it writes. Nothing else.
- **₹450 Plus** — "Buy somewhere to act on it." Adds Ally Chat, Next Steps, Goals, Plan Your Day.
- **₹999 Pro** — "Ally starts initiating." Adds Vision, Recommendations, knowledge-base reasoning, email outreach, and first pick of every call slot.

3. Step-by-step flow

3.1 First-run — signup to report

#	Step	Route	Key API	What must be true
1	Land, redirected if no session	/	POST /auth/resume	No session → waitlist site. Never a white screen.
2	Enter email	/guided/login	Supabase signInWith0tp	Unapproved email → the waitlist message, not a generic failure
3	Enter emailed code, choose a password	/guided/login	Supabase verify0tp + updateUser	A password Supabase rejects stops the step — never "saved" falsely
4	Exchange for a backend session	—	POST /auth/session	Returns {access_token, refresh_token, founder, provisioned:true}
5	See what Ally does	/guided/expectation → /ally-intro	—	—
6	Accept terms + diagnosis consent	/guided/welcome	POST /consents	Append-only; a double-submit does not duplicate the row
7	Build the profile	/guided/profile	PATCH /profile	4 sections, branching by path
8	Stage tour, summary, validate	/guided/tour , /summary , /validate	GET /profile , /progress	Real stage label, never a fallback
9	State the problem	/guided/problem	—	Hands off to the real engine
P	Pay, or redeem a coupon	/app/billing	POST /coupons/validate , POST /payments/checkout or POST /coupons/redeem	Step position not yet decided (\$9-1). It sits at A (before step 5), B (here), or C (before step 14). Everything after it is unreachable without an active plan.
10	Phase 1 — Founder DNA	/app/founder-dna-journey	POST /diagnosis/*	/diagnosis/start 409s until this completes
11	Phase 2 — Current Problem	/app/current-problem	—	Reached from Phase 1, not linked directly
12	Phase 3 — Diagnosis	/app/diagnosis	POST /diagnosis/start , /answer , GET /current	Resumable across reloads; server holds the session
13	Generation	/app/thinking	POST /internal/jobs/reconcile-reports as backstop	A killed container must not strand a COMPLETED session
14	Read the report	/app/report	GET /intelligence/reports/latest	404 before any diagnosis is a legitimate empty state
15	Founder DNA / Business DNA / Next Steps	/app/founder-dna , /business-dna , /next-steps	GET /reports/{id}/*	Never a hardcoded archetype; never [object Object]

3.2 Steady state — a returning founder

1. `/` → `POST /auth/resume` → `/app` dashboard.
2. Dashboard renders the real plan badge, real Clarity Score, real next call — never a placeholder.
3. Ally Chat answers grounded in that founder's own diagnosis; a message is metered against the daily chat ceiling and the credit balance.
4. Plan Your Day auto-creates today's plan on first visit; tasks persist server-side.
5. Hitting a ceiling produces an honest, actionable wall: **429** daily limit, **402** credits spent *or trial lapsed* (the two are distinguished by date and worded differently), **403** the feature is on a higher tier.
6. Every wall routes to `/app/billing`.

3.3 Getting a plan — the two paths (target state, §5)

Path 1 — pay (with or without a discount code)

#	Step	API
1	Open pricing, see live catalog + strike-through MRP	<code>GET /plans</code>
2	Enter a coupon code, see the discounted total	<code>POST /coupons/validate</code>
3	Start checkout	<code>POST /payments/checkout</code> → Razorpay subscription
4	Authorise the mandate in the Razorpay modal	Razorpay
5	Backend grants the plan from the signed webhook only	<code>POST /webhooks/razorpay</code>
6	Credits granted, entitlements widen immediately	—
7	Month 2 onward: auto-charge, credits renew, ledger row appended	<code>subscription.charged</code>
8	Cancel → access continues to period end, then the plan lapses	<code>POST /payments/subscription/cancel</code> + expiry sweep

Path 2 — redeem a 100% comp

#	Step	API
1	Enter the comp code	<code>POST /coupons/validate</code> → <code>{ final_inr: 0, comp: true }</code>
2	Redeem — the gateway is never called	<code>POST /coupons/redeem</code>
3	Server grants the plan directly, writes the redemption row and an audit entry, in one transaction	—
4	Comp period is stamped with an explicit end date	—
5	At period end the founder lapses — no mandate exists, so nothing auto-charges	expiry sweep

The asymmetry in step 5 is the whole risk of this model: a comped founder is a **manual re-conversion**, not a renewal. See §9, Decision 3.

3.4 Discovery call

1. `GET /discovery/slots?days=7` — Pro sees from tomorrow, others from day 3.
 2. `POST /discovery/book` creates a **pending request**.
 3. Team confirms; the row moves `pending` → `confirmed`; Google Calendar event created; confirmation email sent.
 4. Reminders fire at 24h and 1h (**requires the scheduler in §6**).
 5. Payment beyond the free allowance is collected offline against `payment_reference`.
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4. Admin requirements

4.1 Roles

Three roles, server-enforced, capability-counted: **super_admin (13)** · **admin (6)** · **support (3)**. Everything below is checked server-side; the panel only mirrors it.

4.2 Capabilities — live today

Area	Capability	super_admin	admin	support
Users	Search / list (name, email, phone, business, ID), paginate, sort	✓	✓	✓
Users	Founder detail — profile, credits, timeline	✓	✓	✓
Users	Edit founder record	✓	✓	✗
Users	Suspend / restore account status	✓	✓	✗
Users	Reset diagnosis · reset conversations	✓	✓	✗
Users	Delete account · cancel a scheduled deletion	✓	✗	✗
Money	View credit ledger	✓	✓	✓
Money	Adjust credits	✓	✗	✗
Money	Bulk credit grant	✓	✗	✗
Money	Patch a subscription	✓	✗	✗
Support	Inspect a founder's conversations	✓	✓	✗
Support	Regenerate a report	✓	✓	✗
Support	Founder feedback + stats	✓	✓	✓
Privacy	Privacy-request queue, mark handled	✓	✓	✗
System	Feature flags — global and per-founder	✓	✗	✗
System	Broadcasts — create, list, delete	✓	✗	✗
System	Usage + estimated cost, system-wide and per-founder	✓	✓	✗
System	Reconcile unbilled usage	✓	✗	✗
System	Health report	✓	✓	✓
Audit	Immutable audit log, newest first	✓	✓	✓

Every write above appends an audit row. The audit log is append-only and cannot be edited from the panel.

4.3 Admin requirements added for MVP 1.0

Requirement	Why
Coupon CRUD — create, list, disable; type (percent / flat), value, expiry, max redemptions, per-founder limit	Launch promos and partner codes are run by the team, not by a deploy
Coupon redemption report — who redeemed what, discount given, revenue impact	A code with no reporting is a discount you cannot measure
Subscription view — mandate state, next charge date, last charge, failures	Support cannot answer "why was I charged" without it

Requirement	Why
Cancel / refund a subscription from the panel	Today the only cancel path is Razorpay's own dashboard
Failed-payment queue — subscriptions in <code>halted</code> or retrying	A silent dunning failure is churn nobody saw
Waitlist approval view (read-only is acceptable for 1.0)	Approval currently happens outside the product

4.4 Operational requirements

Requirement	Status
Scheduler (EventBridge / pg_cron) calling the internal job endpoints	Missing — blocking
Migration runbook — migrations do not run on deploy; the ECS task definition's <code>command</code> replaces the image <code>CMD</code>	Documented in <code>DEPLOY.md</code> , must be in the release checklist
Monthly partition creation	Endpoint exists, unscheduled
Sentry alerting on <code>ally.usage.reconciliation</code>	Logger namespace exists for exactly this

5. Subscription & coupon flow

5.1 Where we are

A founder pays through `POST /payments/checkout`, which creates a **one-time Razorpay order**. On `payment.captured`, the signed webhook grants the plan, writes a `subscriptions` row with `expires_at = now + 30 days`, and grants the month's credits. The grant is idempotent and never trusts the browser redirect — that part is right and stays.

What is wrong: nothing ever reads `expires_at` back. There is no mandate, no second charge, and no downgrade. A founder who pays ₹999 once holds Pro permanently. Meanwhile the Billing page tells them their subscription renews on a hardcoded date and offers a Cancel button that closes a modal and does nothing.

5.2 Target subscription flow



Rules that must hold:

- 1. A plan is granted **only** from a signature-verified webhook. Never from a redirect, never from a client call.
- 2. Every webhook handler is idempotent — Razorpay retries anything that is not a 2xx, and a double grant is a double month.
- 3. Cancellation is **at period end**, never immediate. The founder paid for the month.
- 4. Downgrade narrows entitlements but **never deletes data**. A founder who returns finds their reports, goals and history intact. Under Decision 5 the downgrade target is the no-access state, not a trial — see §5.5 and §9-2.
- 5. Credits expire before they renew at a period boundary — an unused allowance must not roll over.
- 6. A credit-grant failure must not roll back a plan grant already committed; it is logged loudly and reconciled.

5.3 Coupon flow — the acquisition mechanism

Decision 5 makes this the way founders get in, not a discount on the way in. Every code is admin-issued; nothing self-serve generates one.

Model. A coupon is: a code, a type, a value, an optional tier restriction, an optional binding to a single email, an expiry date, a maximum total redemption count, and a one-redemption-per-founder rule. Redemptions are recorded in their own append-only table.

Type	Effect	Path
percent	N% off the first charge	Gateway — discounted mandate
flat	₹N off the first charge	Gateway — discounted mandate
comp	100% — the plan is granted outright for a stated period	Server-side grant; the gateway is never called

Why comp is a different code path, not a 100% discount. Razorpay cannot create an order or a mandate for ₹0. A comp therefore cannot be expressed as a discounted checkout — it has to be a direct grant. That makes it the most sensitive surface in the product: it hands out paid plans with no payment. It is admin-issued only, always capped, always expiring, always audited, and never generated by anything a founder controls.

Decision 5 it is the smallest possible first payment in the product — the cheapest way for a founder to pay *something* — and the natural landing spot for anyone who exhausts a comped month.

5.5 Withdrawing the Free tier

Do not delete the tier. Redefine it.

`get_plan()` already resolves any unknown, missing or malformed `plan_type` to `free`, deliberately failing `closed` so that a typo grants the least rather than the most. If `free` is redefined from "trial tier" to "**no active subscription, no access**", that existing fallback becomes genuinely safe instead of accidentally generous, and every call site keeps working while granting less.

Deleting the tier instead would mean migrating every `founders.plan_type` row, changing the CHECK constraint on two tables, and finding a new fallback for `get_plan()` — a large, risky change that buys nothing a redefinition does not.

So:

Change	Detail
<code>PLANS[FREE].features</code>	→ empty, or whatever \$9 Decision 2 settles for the lapsed state
<code>signup_credits</code>	1,431 → 0
<code>monthly_credits</code> , both daily ceilings	→ 0
<code>sold_plans()</code>	Free already excluded — no change
Pricing page	Free column removed; three paid tiers plus the coupon field
Copy everywhere	No "free", "trial", or "one month free" language survives. <code>PLANS[FREE].tagline</code> currently reads "One month free. See what Ally finds."
Expiry sweep target	A lapsed subscription lands on <code>free</code> , which now means no access

This also resolves P0-5. The problem was never that Free was mis-sized; it is that Free was a funded trial at all. Decision 5 removes the tier from the ladder, so there is no ceiling left to rebalance — only a lapsed state to define.

6. Launch-critical fixes

P0 — blocks a paid launch

#	Issue	Evidence	Fix
P0-1	No recurring billing. One-time order; <code>subscriptions.expires_at</code> written and never read. Paid tiers never lapse.	<code>app/payments/service.py:139-145</code>	Razorpay Subscriptions + the four webhook events + nightly expiry sweep (\$5.2)
P0-2	Billing page states a false renewal date and a fake cancel. Hardcoded "August 1, 2026"; Cancel confirm handler is <code>setCancelModal(false)</code> . Status view reads <code>MOCK_PLANS</code> .	<code>frontend/src/pages/Billing.jsx:566, 599, 617, 581</code>	Wire to the real subscription API; real cancel; delete the mock fallback from the status view

#	Issue	Evidence	Fix
P0-3	No coupon system exists. Zero occurrences repo-wide. Under Decision 5 this is no longer a promo feature — it is the only way a founder gets in without paying full price, so it is the funnel .	—	Build \$5.3, including the <code>comp</code> grant path
P0-4	Top-up advertised, unpurchasable.	<code>app/api/v1/plans/router.py:48</code> vs <code>payments/router.py</code>	Add the top-up checkout path
P0-5	The Free tier must be withdrawn (Decision 5). It is currently a funded trial sized for internal testing — 8,000 tokens/day, <i>above</i> Plus (3,500) and level with Pro, carrying three ₹999 surfaces.	<code>app/plans/catalog.py:222-260</code> , flagged in the file's own comments	\$5.5 — redefine <code>free</code> as the no-access state rather than deleting the tier. Supersedes the earlier "resize it" fix.
P0-6	No scheduler in production. Discovery reminders, the account-deletion sweep, report reconciliation and partition creation are all endpoints nothing calls.	<code>webhooks/internal_jobs.py</code>	EventBridge (or <code>pg_cron</code>) hitting the internal endpoints with <code>INTERNAL_JOBS_SECRET</code>
P0-11	The diagnosis engine has never been run against a live model. Nine reasoning flags gate whether a model is involved at all, and every one defaults off. Worse, nothing fails when they are: the engines degrade to deterministic paths and the API keeps returning 200s, so a green run is not evidence a model was ever called.	<code>app/core/config.py:124,149,156,169,411,430,448,453</code> ; <code>scripts/verify_llm_integration.py</code>	Configure a key, turn the flags on, run the preflight, then drive a full diagnosis end-to-end and read the report by hand
P0-12	Chat silently answers from the mock when unconfigured. <code>ALLY_LLM_PROVIDER</code> defaults to <code>"mock"</code> , and <code>build_routing_policy</code> falls back to the mock whenever the selected provider has no key — without raising. <code>FailoverLLMProvider</code> also keeps mock as the last link by design, so a provider outage fabricates an answer rather than failing. This has already happened once: the module's own docstring records chat replying "Grounded answer from mock-standard" and reporting success, with whether it happened depending on import order.	<code>app/integrations/llm/settings.py:8,36-43,109,131</code>	Assert at startup that production never resolves to <code>mock</code> , and drop <code>mock</code> from any production fallback chain

#	Issue	Evidence	Fix
P0-13	diagnosis_scoring_configured is false by default. <code>ADAPTIVE_QUESTIONS=False</code> and <code>ANSWER_CLASSIFIER="stored"</code> together mean no answer is ever banded, so every diagnosis yields a report with no evidence behind it. The code names this as the direct cause of a past P0 and logs an error at startup — but only logs it.	<code>app/core/config.py:500-517</code> , <code>app/main.py:176</code>	Set <code>ADAPTIVE_QUESTIONS=true</code> (preferred) or <code>ANSWER_CLASSIFIER=llm</code> , and make it a startup refusal in production rather than a log line
P0-8	No comp grant path. A ₹0 redemption cannot go through Razorpay, so "some founders get a plan free" is currently unimplementable by any route.	—	\$5.3 — <code>POST /coupons/redeem</code> , transactional grant + redemption + audit, admin-issued codes only
P0-9	No lapsed state exists. Today "downgrade" means moving to Free, which grants a full trial's worth of access. Once Free means no-access, every expiry, cancellation and comp exit lands there — and what a lapsed founder can still see is undecided (§9-2).	<code>app/plans/catalog.py</code> , expiry sweep	Define the state, then build it. Blocking: the sweep in P0-1 has nowhere correct to land until this is settled
P0-10	Paywall position is undecided (§9-1) and gates the onboarding build. Positions A, B and C imply different screens, different drop-off, and different LLM cost exposure for non-payers.	\$2 diagram	Product decision required before the onboarding and billing work can be sequenced
P0-7	RAZORPAY_* keys absent from .env.example . A deploy that forgets them silently disables payments — <code>payments_configured</code> returns false and checkout 500s.	<code>backend/.env.example</code>	Document all three keys; assert at startup in production

Verifying the engine — the order to do it in

`scripts/verify_llm_integration.py` is the preflight. It needs no database, writes nothing, and uses the app's own resolution code rather than reimplementing it, so it reports what the product will actually do. It exists because a passing test run cannot tell you a model was involved:

```
python scripts/verify_llm_integration.py
```

It checks all nine reasoning flags and what each degrades to, whether the classifier has a vendor and a key, **what the chat path resolves to — failing if that is the mock**, a real probe call to every configured provider (asserting the response is stamped with that vendor, not `mock`), and the retrieval/embedding configuration. Exit 0 means genuinely wired; non-zero names the flag or key responsible.

Then, in order:

1. **Preflight** — green, with a real provider probed and no mock resolution.
2. **Drive one full diagnosis end-to-end**, using the harness promoted per P1-7. It answers as a realistic Stage-0 founder, so the output is judgeable.

3. **Read the report by hand.** This is the step no script replaces. Confidence scores, root-cause ranking, the archetype and the narrative prose are all now model-produced, and the only way to know whether they are *right* — rather than merely present — is for someone who knows the product to read one and say so.
4. **Check `narrator_provenance` on every report section.** Sections that fell back to template prose record it, so a report that looks written may still be half-generated. If provenance says template where it should say model, the flag or the call is failing silently.
5. **Re-run with each flag toggled off in turn,** to confirm the degraded paths still produce a coherent report. Every one of these is a live production failure mode, not a hypothetical.

Budget for it: a diagnosis is roughly 24,400 tokens and answers are classified six at a time, so a full run is inexpensive but not instant.

P1 — must be right at launch

#	Issue	Evidence	Fix
P1-1	Every tier has <code>free_calls_per_month = 0</code> , so no plan includes a call, yet Pro is positioned on coaching access and the QA sheet expects Pro to have two.	<code>catalog.py:241, 275, 291, 303</code>	Decide the allowance per tier and set it — or remove the free-call language from Pro's positioning
P1-2	Paid calls have no payment path. Booking is a request; ₹300 is collected offline.	<code>discovery/routes.py:108-132</code>	Acceptable for 1.0 if the ops process is written down and the UI says "the team will confirm and share payment details" — not "pay ₹300"
P1-3	Error boundary does not reset on navigation. One crash keeps sibling routes broken until a manual reload.	<code>MANUAL_QA_CHECKLIST.md §12</code>	Key the boundary on the route
P1-4	Know My Energy is sold but not finished. Declared in Pro's feature set.	<code>catalog.py:300</code>	Finish it, or remove it from the advertised set until it ships
P1-5	Docs contradict the product. <code>backend/README.md</code> says "social login only — Google and LinkedIn, no passwords"; the product ships email + OTP + password. <code>backend/PROGRESS.md</code> says the diagnosis engine is unbuilt; it is built.	<code>backend/README.md</code> , <code>backend/PROGRESS.md</code>	Rewrite both. A new engineer onboarding off these docs starts wrong.
P1-6	Build artefacts committed. <code>frontend.zip</code> (1.6 MB), and the captured API responses <code>backend/cur.json</code> / <code>sum.json</code> .	<code>git ls-files</code>	Delete and gitignore
P1-7	Two real diagnosis harnesses are sitting in scratch files. <code>_tmp_run_diagnosis.py</code> drives a full diagnosis over HTTP and <code>_tmp_diag.py</code> does it in-process via <code>TestClient</code> , both answering as a realistic Stage-0 founder from a hand-written bank of 20+ in-character answers. That is most of the end-to-end test P0-11 needs.	<code>backend/_tmp_*.py</code>	Promote, do not delete — move into <code>scripts/</code> as the diagnosis E2E harness

P2 — do it in the launch window if it fits

#	Issue
P2-1	GST handling — the success screen says "+ GST" but no tax line is computed or stored anywhere
P2-2	Invoice / receipt generation — Razorpay's email is the only record a founder gets
P2-3	Dunning emails on a failed charge (currently only an admin-side signal)
P2-4	Full 375px pass over the newer routes (frameworks, achievements, journey, help)

Exit criteria — 1.0 ships when all of these are true

- [] A real card is charged, renews on the second cycle, and can be cancelled from inside the product
- [] A cancelled subscription lapses at period end, automatically, with data intact
- [] A launch code applies a server-computed discount and cannot be redeemed twice
- [] A 100% comp code grants a plan without touching the gateway, is capped, expires, and appears in the audit log naming the admin who issued it
- [] No route into the product is reachable without an active plan, from whichever paywall position §9-1 settles on
- [] The Free tier is withdrawn: no "free" or "trial" copy survives anywhere in the product, and a lapsed founder lands in the defined state rather than on a trial's worth of access
- [] The scheduler is live and every internal job has run successfully at least once in production
- [] `MANUAL_QA_CHECKLIST.md` passes end to end on production, on desktop and at 375px
- [] `scripts/verify_llm_integration.py` exits 0 against production configuration, with a real provider probed and nothing resolving to the mock
- [] At least one complete diagnosis has been run against a live model and its report read end to end by a person, with `narrator_provenance` confirming the sections were model-written
- [] Zero console errors and zero 5xx across a full founder journey
- [] Every screen a founder can reach shows real data or an honest empty state — no mock, no hardcoded date, no fabricated name

7. What is included in MVP 1.0

Everything currently built, made correct, and every feature working — per Decision #3. Nothing ships visible-but-unfinished, which makes Know My Energy and the discovery-reminder scheduler required rather than optional. Concretely:

1. **Access** — waitlist-gated email + OTP + password auth, backend session tokens, rotation, logout.
 2. **Onboarding** — the full guided flow through consent, profile, stage and problem statement.
 3. **The three-phase diagnosis** — Founder DNA, Current Problem, and the adaptive stage-scoped business diagnosis with confidence-based routing.
 4. **The outputs** — Clarity Report with a Clarity Score, Founder DNA, Business DNA across six readiness pillars, root-cause chain, Next Steps.
 5. **The workspace** — Dashboard, Ally Chat (grounded, streaming, attachments, voice), Plan Your Day, Goals, Next Steps, Vision, Recommendations, Knowledge chat, Frameworks, Achievements, Journey, Notifications, Help assistant, Profile, Settings, Feedback.
 6. **Discovery calls** — live Google Calendar slots, request-and-confirm booking, priority lead time for Pro, confirmation and reminder emails.
 7. **Money** — the three-tier paid ladder (₹199 Starter · ₹450 Plus · ₹999 Pro) with **no free tier**, credits with lazy settlement, daily token ceilings, server-side entitlements, **auto-renewing Razorpay subscriptions**, the **coupon system including 100% comps**, and the ₹300 top-up.
 8. **Admin** — the full panel with three-role RBAC, plus the coupon, subscription and failed-payment additions in §4.3, all audited.
 9. **Trust** — export, restrict, withdraw, 30-day scheduled deletion, Terms, Privacy, Sentry.
 10. **Operations** — a live scheduler, a written migration runbook, and reconciliation alerting.
-

8. Post-launch roadmap

8.1 Release 1.1 — the first month after launch

Item	Why it waits
Annual plans and annual pricing	Needs the monthly mandate proven first
Recurring / multi-cycle coupon discounts	Needs Razorpay plan-level offers, a different model from launch codes
Referral programme	Depends on the coupon primitives landing in 1.0
GST invoicing and downloadable receipts	Compliance follow-through on P2-1 / P2-2
Self-serve plan change (upgrade/downgrade mid-cycle with proration)	1.0 supports upgrade at renewal only
Paid discovery calls checked out in-product	Removes the manual ops step in P1-2
Dunning email sequence	Reduces involuntary churn once there is churn to measure

8.2 Release 1.2 — deepening the product

Item
Repeat / periodic diagnosis — re-run the assessment and diff the Clarity Score over time
Founder intelligence: cross-founder pattern detection and benchmarking
Founder memory smart-update — memory that revises itself as the founder changes
Team seats and multi-founder accounts
Native mobile or PWA
Coach-side console for the human coaching layer
Visual question bank (<code>visual_question_bank</code> is seeded empty)

8.3 Release 1.3+ — platform

Item
Public API / integrations
Slack and WhatsApp surfaces for Ally
Cohort and accelerator accounts (B2B2C)
Evaluation framework running continuously against live diagnoses
Migration from Supabase to AWS Cognito (already a one-provider swap by design)
Model routing and cost optimisation across providers

8.4 Explicitly not on the roadmap

- Lifting the waitlist to open public signup — a separate go-to-market decision, not an engineering one.
 - A free tier of any kind, permanent or trial. Decision 5 withdrew it; the coupon is the only route to a plan below list price.
 - Qdrant. The implementation uses pgvector and that divergence from the original PRD is treated as intentional and settled.
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9. Open decisions

Decision 5 (no free tier) is locked. Four consequences of it are **deliberately not yet decided** and are recorded here with their options, so the build can proceed on everything that does not depend on them. Decisions 1-3 are on the critical path: the onboarding, billing and expiry work cannot be finished without them.

9-1. Where the paywall sits — blocks P0-10

The candidate positions are marked in the §2 diagram.

Option	What it means	For	Against
A — at signup	Pay or redeem immediately after waitlist approval, before onboarding	Simplest to build and explain; zero free compute given away	The coldest possible ask; onboarding drop-off becomes revenue drop-off
B — after onboarding, before diagnosis	Founder completes profile, stage and problem statement, sees what Ally will do, then pays	They have invested effort and understand the offer; the expensive part (~24,400 unmetered tokens per diagnosis) is never spent on a non-payer	Some drop-off is simply deferred, not recovered
C — after diagnosis, before the report	Answer everything, then pay to unlock the Clarity Report	Highest conversion — the founder wants the answer they can already feel is coming	Funds every non-payer's full diagnosis; reads as bait-and-switch to some founders

Owner: Product · **Note:** whichever is chosen, every route below it must fail closed server-side, not merely be hidden in the UI.

9-2. What a founder with no active plan can see — blocks P0-9

Applies to three populations at once: never paid, lapsed after paying, and a comp that ended.

Option	What it means	For	Against
Past reports read-only	Keep what they already paid for; everything else paywalled	Best reason to come back; never destroys purchased work	More surface to keep correct in a state nobody tests often
Full lockout	Nothing until they pay again	Strongest renewal pressure	A founder who paid ₹999 loses access to their own diagnosis — reads as punitive
Dashboard + report, no AI surfaces	Shell, Clarity Score and report stay; anything costing a model call is locked	More product visible, so upgrade prompts land better	The largest of the three to build and keep honest

Owner: Product · **Note:** whatever is chosen, **no founder data is ever deleted on lapse**. Access narrows; the record stays.

9-3. What happens when a 100% comp ends — blocks P0-1's sweep semantics

A comped founder never authorised a mandate, because no charge ever happened. There is nothing to auto-renew.

Option	What it means	For	Against
Lapse, then prompt to pay	Comp runs N cycles, founder lapses, must actively pay	Honest; no billing surprise; no mandate needed	Every comp renewal is a manual conversion you have to earn
Take a mandate at redemption	Authorise a mandate even at ₹0 (via a ₹1 authorisation and refund) so cycle N+1 charges automatically	Far better retention; turns comps into real subscriptions	A genuine e-mandate compliance path, and a founder who may not expect the charge

Option	What it means	For	Against
Indefinite comp	Some codes never expire; revocable from the panel	Necessary for advisors, partners and design partners	Dangerous as anything other than a small, named list

Owner: Product / Finance · **Note:** these are not exclusive — the likely answer is a default plus a small indefinite list, but the default must be chosen.

9-4. Existing Free-tier founders — no action taken pending this

Today's testers hold `plan_type='free'` with the testing-phase allowance. When Free is redefined to no-access (\$5.5) they lose access **at that moment** unless something is done first.

Option	For	Against
Issue comp codes before the switch	Nobody loses access unannounced; doubles as the first live test of the comp path	Requires the coupon system to ship before the ladder flips — an ordering constraint on the release
Grandfather them	Simplest for the testers	A permanent second class of account to reason about in every gate, forever
Lapse them with everyone else	Cleanest model	May cost you the testers currently giving feedback

Owner: Product · **Status:** explicitly deferred — **do nothing until this is decided.** The ordering constraint is the thing to watch: if comp codes are the answer, the coupon system must ship before Free is withdrawn, not with it.

9-5. Carried over from before Decision 5

#	Decision	Owner	Blocks
a	Free discovery calls per tier — or drop the claim from Pro's positioning	Product	P1-1
b	Launch coupon slate — which codes, what discount, how many comps, what expiry	Product / GTM	P0-3
c	Sign-off on the confidence-formula weights	Viraj	Engine calibration
d	"Core questions expected per stage" and the minimum-question floor	Product	Confidence coverage denominator
e	Whether <code>business_dimensions</code> (empty, superseded by <code>readiness_pillars</code>) is dropped	Team	Schema hygiene
f	Which provider and model the diagnosis engine runs on in production, and the monthly token budget that implies	Product / Eng	P0-11
g	Which of the nine reasoning flags are on at launch — each one off is a surface running deterministically, which is a product choice, not only a config one	Product	P0-11

(The former Decision 1, "Free-tier launch sizing", is closed: Decision 5 withdraws the tier, so there is no ladder left to size — only the lapsed state in 9-2 to define.)